

SENATE No. 1768

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Bruce E. Tarr

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to the use of green lights for municipal emergency management vehicles.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>Bruce E. Tarr</i>	<i>First Essex and Middlesex</i>	
<i>Peter J. Durant</i>	<i>Worcester and Hampshire</i>	<i>3/17/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>6/12/2025</i>

SENATE No. 1768

By Mr. Tarr, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 1768) of Bruce E. Tarr for legislation relative to the use of green lights for municipal emergency management vehicles. Public Safety and Homeland Security.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE SENATE, NO. 1589 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to the use of green lights for municipal emergency management vehicles.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 90 as appearing in the 2022 official edition is hereby amended by inserting after
2 section 7E the following new section: 7E1/2.. No motor vehicle operated pursuant to section
3 seven other than municipal emergency management vehicles shall mount or display a flashing,
4 rotating or oscillating green light in any direction, except as herein provided; provided, however,
5 that nothing in this section shall prohibit an official police vehicle from displaying a flashing,
6 rotating or oscillating red light in the opposite direction in which the vehicle is proceeding or
7 prohibit fire apparatus from displaying a flashing, rotating or oscillating blue light in the opposite
8 direction in which the vehicle is proceeding.

9 A vehicle owned or operated by the municipal emergency management as appointed by
10 the municipal governing body may have mounted thereon flashing, rotating or oscillating green

lights. Such lights shall only be displayed when such owner or operator is proceeding to an emergency or in response to an alarm and when the official duty of such owner or operator requires them to proceed to said emergency or to respond to said alarm, and at no other time.

No such green light shall be mounted or displayed on such vehicle until proper application has been made to the registrar by the emergency management director as appointed by the municipalities governing body and a written permit has been issued and delivered to the owner and operator. In the event that the operator is not the registered owner of the vehicle, no permit shall be issued until said owner forwards to the registrar a written statement certifying that he has knowledge that such red light will be mounted and displayed on said vehicle.

Any person operating a vehicle upon which flashing, rotating or oscillating green lights herein authorized are mounted shall have the permit for said lights upon their person or in the vehicle in some easily accessible place. Upon termination of the duties which warranted the issuance of the permit, the mayor or chair of the board of selectmen shall immediately notify the registrar who shall forthwith revoke such green light permit. Upon the written request of the mayor or board of selectmen of the municipality in which such permitted vehicle is registered, the registrar may revoke such permit. The registrar shall revoke such permit for the unauthorized use of such green lights and the owner and operator shall be subject to a fine as hereinafter provided.

Upon revocation, the registrar of motor vehicles shall notify forthwith the owner and operator of the vehicle for which such permit was issued and the head of the police department and fire department of the municipality in which his original permit was issued.

32 The registrar may also make such rules and regulations governing or prohibiting the
33 display of such other lights on motor vehicles as he may deem necessary for public safety.

34 Any person who violates any provision of this section for which a penalty is not
35 otherwise provided shall be subject to a fine of not less than one hundred dollars, nor more than
36 three hundred dollars.